

Using the converter, you can manage output options such as the output format (MPEG-2 or MPEG-1) and aspect ratio (4:3 and 16:9). Then you can choose between three different settings for each aspect ratio. The first is 'Fullscreen' - this option resizes the video to 720 x 576 or 720 x 480 (or other resolutions if doing (S)VCD). Avoid using this option as it could lead to some deformation in the output. The second option is 'Add borders, keep aspect ratio', which adds horizontal or vertical borders to maintain aspect ratio. The third is 'Crop video, keep aspect ratio' - this crops the video so that there will be no borders, but the aspect ratio will be maintained. This can be used to give a picture-in-picture effect.

In addition to these features, you can also select the size of your CD or DVD, and the number of CDs you want to make. Normally you can make a VCD on one CD and a SVCD on two. You can also select an audio bitrate that The FilmMachine will use. The FilmMachine can also make permanent subtitles for your DVD or (S)VCD movies. You do this by selecting a subtitle format - .srt or .sub. The subtitles will be merged when you have more than one subtitle file. You also have the option to select the subtitle language.

4.4.2 D.I.K.O

DIKO is a one-click DivX/XVid to DVD/SVCD conversion tool. It encodes the required file using CinemaCraft Encoder 2.66 or 2.67, or using Nic's free encoder QuEnc; the latter comes bundled with the DIKO installation package. DIKO comes loaded with a number of features such as automatic bitrate calculation, conversion of audio, and automatic frame rate conversions including the audio and subtitles. The tool can execute frame rate conversions even with 5.1-channel audio. One of the most interesting aspects of this tool was subtitles for a 2-CD DivX movies can be joined on the fly. This means you can add subtitles to a movie as it is being converted from one format to the other.

The tool has inbuilt capabilities to check for errors and avoid bad-quality encoding. DIKO lets you add multiple file for conversions in the movie list. Both files must have the same properties,